Unit 9 · Comparatives and superlatives

Name _____

THE BIG IDEA

To compare TWO things we use -er + than. To say which one is number one we use the + -est.

Сравниваем ДВА предмета — -er + than. Самый-самый — the + -est.

How we build it

WHICH	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	РУССКИЙ
Compare 2	adjective -er than	**The giraffe is taller than the zebra.**	Жираф выше зебры.
Number 1	the adjective -est	**The giraffe is the tallest.**	Жираф самый высокий.
ends in e	just add -r / -st	**large → larger → the largest**	
short vowel + consonant	double the last letter	**big → bigger → the biggest**	
ends in y	y → ier / iest	**heavy → heavier → the heaviest**	
Long words	more / the most adjective	**beautiful → more beautiful → the most beautiful**	
Irregular	learn by heart	**good → better → the best · bad → worse → the worst**	

When we use it

Compare two animals: A horse is faster than a cow.
Сравнить двух животных.

Pick the winner: The cheetah is the fastest animal.
Назвать лучшего.

Compare people: I'm taller than my brother.
Сравнить людей.

REMEMBER

Two things? → -er + than. Three or more (or 'of all')? → the + -est.

RUSSIAN AND ENGLISH

Russian: «больше, чем» / «самый большой». English adds -er / -est to SHORT words. Never 'more big' and never two together ('more bigger').

Watch out! We often say...

~~more big~~	**bigger**
~~bigger as~~	**bigger than**
~~the most big~~	**the biggest**
~~the more fast~~	**the fastest**

EASY TRICK

-ER = TWO things (than). -EST = THREE or more (the). Short word → add ER. Long word → add «more». Never both: «more bigger» ✗.

Try it! Circle the right answer

1 An elephant is ___ than a mouse. (big / bigger)

2 A cheetah is ___ animal. (the fastest / faster)

3 big → ___

4 heavy → ___

5 beautiful → ___

6 good → ___ → the best

Answers: 1 bigger · 2 the fastest · 3 bigger · 4 heavier · 5 more beautiful · 6 better